

YOU GOT THE LEAD. NOW WHAT?

Email Journey Starter Kit

A practical worksheet to capture the right information, segment with purpose, score engagement, build nurture paths, and use AI without guessing.

CAPTURE

What should you know at the gate?

OBSERVE

What signals show real interest?

RESPOND

What should happen next?

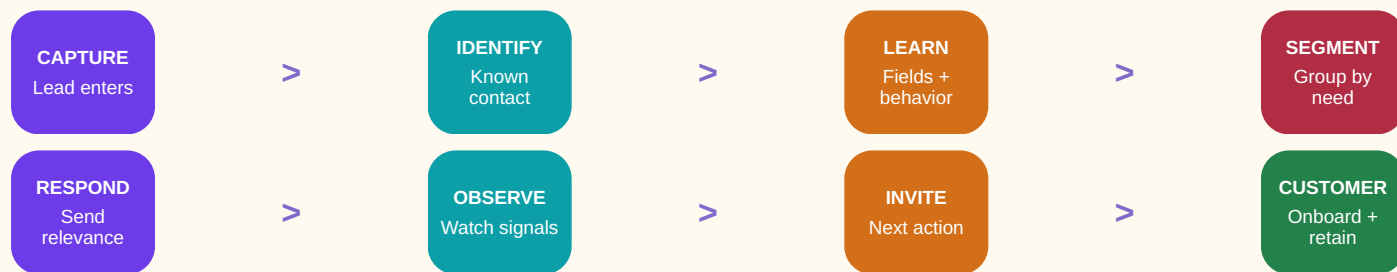
The goal is not to send more email. The goal is to create a path from interest to customer.



1. Map the Lead-to-Next-Step Journey

PARK MAP

Use this as the backbone of your email strategy. Each step should answer one question: **what do we know now, and what is the next appropriate action?**



YOUR STARTING POINT

WHERE ARE LEADS COMING FROM?

WHAT DO THEY RECEIVE FIRST?

WHAT IS THE PRIMARY CONVERSION GOAL?

WHAT SHOULD TRIGGER PERSONAL FOLLOW-UP?

YOUR JOURNEY CHECK

- ☐ Every email has a purpose.
- ☐ Different behavior can change the next message.
- ☐ There is a clear conversion action.
- ☐ Customers move into onboarding or retention.
- ☐ High-intent leads can trigger human follow-up.

Think like the architect: you are designing the experience. Automation and AI can operate parts of the ride, but strategy still comes from you.

2. Smart Intake Builder

AT THE GATE

Your form is your first segmentation tool. Ask for enough information to make the next message relevant, but do not interrogate people at the entrance.

CAPTURE NOW

Information the lead can reasonably give you upfront.

- ☐ First name
- ☐ Email
- ☐ One useful segmentation question
- ☐ Lead source
- ☐ Consent / permission

MY BEST SEGMENTATION QUESTION:

LEARN ALONG THE JOURNEY

Signals you can collect gradually as the lead engages.

- ☐ Topic links clicked
- ☐ Resources downloaded
- ☐ Service / offer pages visited
- ☐ Replies and questions
- ☐ Bookings / demos / quotes
- ☐ Purchases

TURN ANSWERS INTO USABLE CRM DATA

Question / Signal	Store As	Example	Why It Matters
What are you trying to accomplish?	Custom Field	Primary Goal	Changes the nurture message
Which topic did they choose?	Tag	Interest - Growth	Routes to a relevant path
Where did they come from?	Field / Tag	Source - Webinar	Shows acquisition context
Did they book?	Lifecycle / Event	High Intent	Can trigger human follow-up

Progressive profiling: collect useful information gradually. If you only have names and email addresses today, start capturing better signals now. Personalization gets stronger as the profile gets richer.

3. Simple Engagement Score Starter

INTENT METER

Not every signal means the same thing. Use behavior to decide the right follow-up, not to judge whether a lead is "good" or "bad."

Behavior	Starter Points	Signal Strength	Your Score
Opens an email	+1	Weak	—
Clicks a topic link	+5	Moderate	—
Downloads a resource	+7	Moderate	—
Visits a service / offer page	+8	Strong	—
Visits pricing / booking page	+10	High Intent	—
Replies / attends webinar	+10	High Intent	—
Books a call / demo / quote	+25	High Intent	—
Purchases	+30	Customer	—
No meaningful activity for 30-60 days	-5	Decay	—

0-9: EDUCATE

Still learning. Share useful, low-pressure content.

10-19: NURTURE

Interest is growing. Send topic-specific follow-up.

20+: HIGH INTENT

Consider an invitation, booking CTA, or personal follow-up.

Use as a starting assumption, not a universal benchmark. Compare high scores with actual bookings and purchases. Then adjust the weights based on what really predicts conversion in your business.

Email opens are a weak signal. A click, booking, reply, purchase, or high-intent page visit usually tells you much more.

4. Build Three Nurture Paths

CHOOSE THE RIDE

Personalization is not just using someone's name. It is changing the next step because the person showed you something different.

PATH 1: EDUCATE	PATH 2: TOPIC NURTURE	PATH 3: HIGH INTENT
ENTRY CONDITION _____	ENTRY CONDITION _____	ENTRY CONDITION _____
WHAT DO THEY NEED? _____ _____	WHAT DO THEY NEED? _____ _____	WHAT DO THEY NEED? _____ _____
NEXT EMAIL _____ _____	NEXT EMAIL _____ _____	NEXT EMAIL _____ _____
BEHAVIOR TO WATCH _____ _____	BEHAVIOR TO WATCH _____ _____	HUMAN HANDOFF? _____ _____

CHOICE-BASED EMAIL: LET THE LEAD TELL YOU WHAT MATTERS

Build one email with two intentional links. Each click becomes a preference signal and can route the lead into a different path.

CHOICE A

I want to save time.

Tag: Interest - Efficiency

Route: Efficiency nurture

CHOICE B

I want to grow revenue.

Tag: Interest - Growth

Route: Growth nurture

Different action. Different path. Different next message. That is behavioral personalization.

5. AI Prompt Pack

RIDE OPERATOR

Use AI after the lead has given you useful information. The prompts below keep the AI grounded in known data instead of inventing personal details.

PROMPT 1: WELCOME EMAIL

Prompt: Write a warm welcome email for a new lead who joined through [SOURCE] and requested [LEAD MAGNET / OFFER]. The business is [BUSINESS DESCRIPTION]. Known information: [AVAILABLE FIELDS]. Deliver the promised resource, establish relevance, give one useful insight, and include one clear next action. Do not invent personal information. Personalize only using supplied data.

PROMPT 2: CHOICE-BASED EMAIL

Prompt: Create a short nurture email for [AUDIENCE] that offers two clearly different next-step links. The goal is to learn which topic matters most to the lead. Choice A should represent [TOPIC A]. Choice B should represent [TOPIC B]. Keep the message helpful, not pushy. For each choice, suggest the CRM tag that should be applied after the click.

PROMPT 3: SEGMENT-SPECIFIC FOLLOW-UP

Prompt: Write the next email for a lead in the [SEGMENT] segment. Known goal: [GOAL]. Known challenge: [CHALLENGE]. Observed behavior: [BEHAVIOR]. Content already received: [CONTENT]. Desired next action: [CTA]. Give one useful insight and make the next step feel natural. Do not infer facts that are not provided.

PROMPT 4: HIGH-INTENT FOLLOW-UP

Prompt: Draft a concise follow-up for a lead who has demonstrated high intent by [ACTION]. Reference only confirmed information: [KNOWN DATA]. Make the message direct but not aggressive. Invite [BOOKING / QUOTE / DEMO / PURCHASE] as the next step. Include one sentence that makes it easy for the lead to say "not yet" without pressure.

PROMPT 5: BUILD MY JOURNEY

Prompt: Design a simple email nurture journey for a [BUSINESS TYPE] selling [OFFER]. Leads enter from [SOURCE]. Define: what to capture initially, what to learn later from behavior, 3 useful segments, 6 meaningful engagement signals, a starter scoring model, and the next email for low, growing, and high intent. Do not assume tracking capabilities that are not listed here: [CURRENT TOOLS / TRACKING].

6. Your First 3 Actions

LEAVE WITH A PLAN

Do not build the whole park today. Build the next useful part of the journey.

1. CAPTURE

Add one useful segmentation question to your lead form.

MY ACTION:

2. OBSERVE

Choose 3-5 signals you can actually track today.

MY SIGNALS:

3. RESPOND

Create at least two different nurture paths based on what leads do.

MY PATHS:

DO THIS NOW

- ☐ Define the conversion goal.
- ☐ Review the lead form.
- ☐ Create meaningful fields and tags.
- ☐ Track clicks, bookings, and purchases where possible.
- ☐ Build one branching nurture email.

DO NOT OVERCOMPLICATE YET

- ☐ Do not create dozens of tiny segments.
- ☐ Do not treat opens as proof of buying intent.
- ☐ Do not ask for every data point upfront.
- ☐ Do not let AI invent customer facts.
- ☐ Do not automate away necessary human follow-up.

THE SAFETY RAILS

FIRST-PARTY DATA

Capture information intentionally.

CONSENT

Respect permission and opt-outs.

GOOD DATA

Use information you trust.

HUMAN OVERSIGHT

AI suggests. People decide.

Final takeaway: the lead is not the destination. Capture the signal, learn from the behavior, and choose the next best step.